Module 1 Lab 1: AWS Account, IAM User, and Cost Guardrails

20 points. Estimated time 90 to 120 minutes.

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How to use this file. Type your answers straight into the shaded boxes. Do not delete the questions. When you are finished, save this file and upload it with the rest of your submission.

1. Your unique values

These are what make the submission yours. They come from your own account and your own run, so no two students have the same ones.

Your AWS account alias: cs79f-reza

Your IAM user name: ereza-lab

The exact ARN in your AccessDenied message from Step 5:

1. User: arn:aws:iam::317804964135:user/ereza-lab is not authorized to perform: s3:CreateBucket on resource: "arn:aws:s3:::smth-s3-demo-bucket" because no identity-based policy allows the s3:CreateBucket action
2. User: arn:aws:iam::317804964135:user/ereza-lab is not authorized to perform: iam:CreateUser on resource: arn:aws:iam::317804964135:user/second-guy because no identity-based policy allows the iam:CreateUser action. Go to https://us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/iam/home?region=us-east-1#/authorization-details/3s1ggwcccl2epdapj19pb3nyt for complete details, or call the GetRequestAuthorizationDetails API with the following authorization id: 3s1ggwcccl2epdapj19pb3nyt

Your chosen Region: us-east-1, but will change to us-west-1 after this assignment

2. Break it on purpose

Working code shows you what happens. Broken code shows you why. Do each of these deliberately, paste the real error text, and undo the change before moving on.

Break 1. Sign in with your IAM user password but deliberately enter a wrong MFA code.

Paste the exact error text here, not a description of it

Authentication failed
Your authentication information is incorrect. Please try again.

The exact wording of the failure. Note whether it tells you the password was right.

It said that my authentication information was incorrect. Didn't confirm if my password was right.

Break 2. With AdministratorAccess attached, try to close the AWS account from the IAM user. Do not confirm anything.

Paste the exact error text here, not a description of it

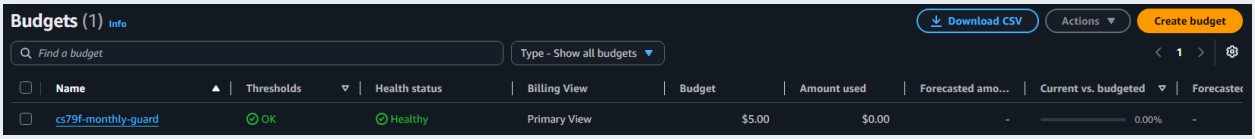
Unable to close account
To close this account, you must sign in as the root user. If you can't sign in, see Troubleshooting issues with the root user. For details about the end-to-end account closure process, see Close an AWS Account. If the account you want to close is part of AWS Organizations, see Closing a member account in your organization.

What the console says about who may close an account, and why that is not covered by AdministratorAccess.

Well, as expected, the root user is the only one allowed to close IAM accounts. From what I understand, this is one of the most common used methods of preventing a hierarchy failure or confusing power-level dynamic, so that you don't end up removing the true administrator.

Break 3. Set your budget threshold to 1 percent temporarily and save it.

Paste the exact error text here, not a description of it



Whether the status changes, and how quickly. Set it back to 85 percent afterward.

The status hasn't changed at all. Putting it to 1% means $0.05, and I don't think I've spent anything… so nothing would change regardless?

3. Results

The numbers and outputs your own run produced.

Your account alias

cs79f-reza

Your IAM user name and ARN

ereza-lab
3178-0496-4135

The budget name and status

cs79f-monthly-guard

The action named in your AccessDenied message

User: arn:aws:iam::317804964135:user/ereza-lab is not authorized to perform: iam:CreateUser on resource: arn:aws:iam::317804964135:user/second-guy because no identity-based policy allows the iam:CreateUser action. Go to https://us-east-1.console.aws.amazon.com/iam/home?region=us-east-1#/authorization-details/3s1ggwcccl2epdapj19pb3nyt for complete details, or call the GetRequestAuthorizationDetails API with the following authorization id: 3s1ggwcccl2epdapj19pb3nyt

4. Reflection

Your own words. No AI assistance on this part. Graders check these answers against the rest of your submission.

Question 1

Explain the shared responsibility model using your own account as the example. Name one thing AWS is responsible for and one thing you became responsible for the moment you created this account.

Not quite sure what is meant by the shared responsibility model, but I'm guessing the responsibility shared between the root and the IAM user? I would say AWS is responsible for purely providing services and control and I am responsible for controlling and managing them. Deleting stuff on accident, leaking keys, inability to access things, they all fall on me and will occur due to my carelessness.

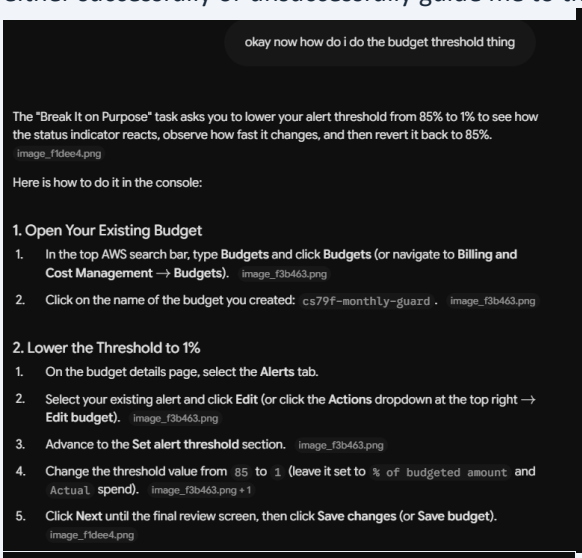
5. AI use disclosure

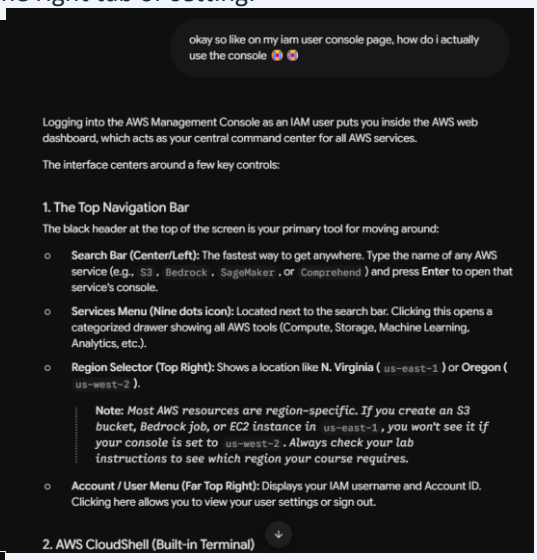
Required by the course AI Use Policy.

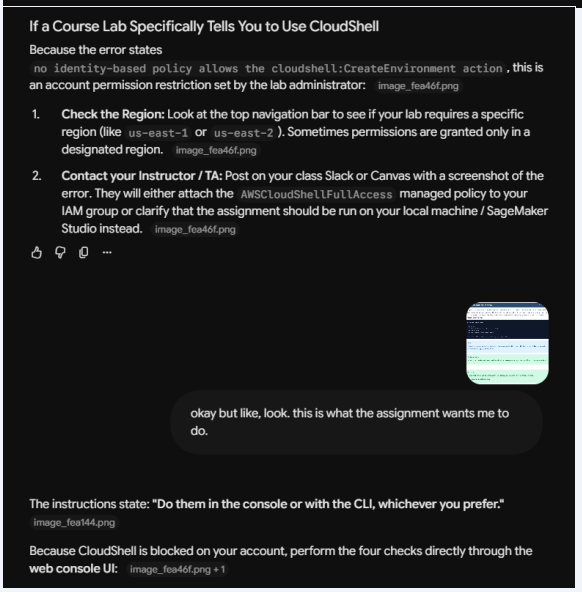
Tool used (write none if you used no AI):
Gemini

If you used one: what you asked it, what you kept, and how you checked it

I just kept sending screenshots of your instructions or the AWS webpage to navigate things or get clarification on what I was supposed to do. I am also sometimes blind and miss things, but the AI would either successfully or unsuccessfully guide me to the right tab or setting.







I basically just ask stuff like this.

6. Before you submit

- ☐ I am signed in as my IAM user, not root
- ☐ I captured a real AccessDenied message with my own account number in it
- ☐ My budget shows status OK
- ☐ I pasted the real error text for every break it item

- ☐ Reflection written by me with no AI assistance
- ☐ Files uploaded individually, no archive